

TIMELINE

- 1911** Born on August 25 in An Xa, a village on the north bank of the Kien Giang River in Quang Binh province.
- 1924** Begins studies at the prestigious Quoc Hoc (National Academy) in Hue.
- 1930** Arrested for his participation in student protests against the French colonial regime.
- 1933–37** Studies law and political economics at Hanoi's National University.
- 1937** Joins the Communist Party.
- 1940** Ordered by the party to flee to southern China; meets Ho Chi Minh.
- 1941–45** Organizes guerrilla resistance against the forces of Nazi-occupied France and of Japan.
- 1944** Forms the Vietnam Armed Propaganda and Liberation Brigade.
- 1946** Issues a national call to arms against the French.
- 1951** Becomes a member of the Politburo, the executive committee of the Communist Party of Vietnam.
- 1954** Plans and leads the Viet Minh victory at Dien Bien Phu, forcing the French to relinquish control of Indochina.
- 1955** Becomes Deputy Prime Minister of the Democratic Republic of Vietnam.
- 1968** Disagrees with the politburo's plan used in the Tet Offensive, an assault on more than 100 targets in South Vietnam.
- 1969** Directs NVA counteroffensive against US activities in Laos.
- 1975** Issues orders for North Vietnam's final offensive and the fall of Saigon.
- 1978** Helps conduct the Vietnamese invasion of Cambodia that topples Pol Pot's regime.
- 1990** Makes high-profile visit to Beijing that sets the stage for normalization of Vietnam-China relations in 1991.
- 2013** Dies on October 4, aged 102.



FUNERAL OF GENERAL GIAP